

dow that mentioned this. It identified the .exe file that was doing this, it identified the destination IP, and said this was “the program’s first attempt to access the Internet.” That’s the level of detail you get!

At the same time, in case such alerts are irritating, there’s even an option in that same pop-up window that asks if you want to have fewer alerts. So we gather that ZoneAlarm is very customisable. Finally, you can choose to allow or deny the program access to the Net.



A typical pop-up brought up by ZoneAlarm. Click “Allow” or “Deny”, or choose “More Info”

Here’s what the screen looks like when you start up ZoneAlarm (see screenshot on previous page). First off, it says you’re protected by ZoneAlarm, and that “no further setup is necessary”—and that ZoneAlarm will alert you if you need to make any adjustments.

There’s an indication of how many intrusions have been blocked since install; there’s an “Inbound Protection” header, which told us how many access attempts the firewall blocked. Then there’s an “Outbound Protection” section, which told us how many programs were currently permitted to use the Internet. The “E-mail Protection” section told us how many suspect e-mail attachments had been quarantined since install.

You can set the level of protection for the Internet Zone and for the Trusted Zone, where you enter the IPs of which computers you ‘trust.’ Under ‘Program Control’, you can choose the level of warnings you receive when programs try to access the Internet—